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THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING

Daily 2026-10-31 Ivanti Connect Secure CVE-2026-118527 Exploitation Priority Update

CVE / Vulnerability Threat Intelligence Report

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1. Executive Summary

CVE-2026-118527 is an Ivanti Connect Secure (ICS) predictable-numbers-or-identifiers weakness that CISA added to the Known Exploited Vulnerabilities (KEV) Catalog on 2026-10-30. CISA's current alert states that it was exploited in a chain with CVE-2026-104935 and CVE-2026-111357. The new KEV entry makes exposed ICS fleets an immediate patch, integrity-validation, and incident-hunting priority.

Public summaries describe a file-upload capability in the documented chain context. This report avoids treating the CVE as universal unauthenticated remote code execution: chain preconditions and remediation details must be taken from Ivanti's advisory. A successful appliance compromise can create a high-impact remote-access trust failure even where downstream endpoint telemetry initially looks normal.

2. Vulnerability Metadata

Field	Value
CVE	CVE-2026-118527
Product	Ivanti Connect Secure
CISA weakness label	Generation of Predictable Numbers or Identifiers
Role in reported activity	File-upload component in a reported chained exploitation sequence
KEV status	Added 2026-10-30
Exploitation status	CISA and Ivanti describe limited customer impact when related CVEs are chained
Primary remediation	Apply Ivanti's current fixed-release guidance and validate appliance integrity
Important limitation	Do not infer unauthenticated RCE from this CVE in isolation

3. Source Review & Confidence

Source	Contribution	Confidence
CISA KEV catalog	Current priority and date of KEV addition	High
CISA Ivanti alert	Exploited-chain and immediate-action context	High
Ivanti security advisory	Product scope, fixed-release and integrity-check guidance	High
Ivanti October security update	Vendor operational remediation reinforcement	High

Source agreement is strong on urgency and the need to follow Ivanti remediation. Exact appliance exposure, exploitation, and post-compromise activity must be established with local logs and integrity-check results.

4. Vulnerability Details

CISA identifies the issue as predictable-number/identifier generation. Public KEV aggregations describe a remote authenticated attacker being able to upload controlled content to a known disk location; CISA's alert situates the issue in the Ivanti chain rather than documenting a standalone attack path. Because ICS often terminates remote access and federates authentication, any unauthorized file or configuration change deserves appliance-level incident handling.

5. Attack Scenarios

Scenario	Preconditions	Potential outcome	Priority action
Reported chained exploitation	Vulnerable ICS and related chain conditions	Unauthorized content written to an appliance location	Patch and run integrity checks
Persistence through altered appliance content	Successful write plus retained management access	Durable access or follow-on execution risk	Compare appliance state, investigate anomalies
Remote-access trust abuse	Appliance controls, sessions, or authentication flow affected	Unauthorized VPN access or lateral movement	Review sign-ins, groups, and device posture events

6. Affected Products and Exposure

Exposure pattern	Why it matters	Required action
Internet-facing ICS gateway	Direct exposure to a KEV-listed chain component	Identify version and remediate immediately
Partner / contractor VPN portal	Third-party accounts increase identity and operational risk	Validate MFA, least privilege, and partner account activity
HA / DR appliance	A clean primary can fail over to an unpatched node	Patch and integrity-check every node
Appliance administrative plane	Write/configuration artifacts may not be seen by endpoint agents	Preserve logs and use Ivanti tooling

7. Mitigation and Workarounds

Priority	Owner	Action	Verification
Critical	Network / IAM	Enumerate every ICS gateway and exposure path	Inventory reconciled to DNS, firewall, and CMDB
Critical	Platform	Apply Ivanti's current fixed-release guidance	Version evidence for every node
Critical	Incident response	Run Ivanti Integrity Checker Tool; preserve before/after output	Findings attached to incident/change record
High	SOC	Baseline and review appliance file/configuration, admin, and authentication events	Hunt outcome recorded

High	IAM	Rotate privileged credentials and invalidate sessions when evidence warrants	Credential and session-control audit

8. Detection Engineering

Signal	Telemetry source	Analytic goal
Unexpected change to appliance content/configuration	ICS audit and integrity-tool output	Detect unauthorized state modification
Unusual administrator or API action	ICS management logs	Detect post-compromise control-plane activity
Novel VPN source networks or atypical session volume	VPN / IdP logs	Detect access abuse after appliance compromise

```
DeviceFileEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(30d)
| where DeviceName has_any ("ivanti", "ics", "pulse")
| where ActionType in~ ("FileCreated", "FileModified")
| project Timestamp, DeviceName, FolderPath, FileName, InitiatingProcessFileName,
InitiatingProcessCommandLine
| order by Timestamp desc
```

```
index=ivanti ("admin" OR "config" OR "upload" OR "integrity")
| stats count values(user) as actors values(src_ip) as source_ips values(object) as objects by action,
host
| sort - count
```

9. Threat Hunting

Hypothesis: an ICS appliance exposed to the reported chain contains unexplained content/configuration changes followed by abnormal remote-access behavior.

```
let suspiciousVpn = SigninLogs
| where TimeGenerated > ago(30d)
| where AppDisplayName has_any ("Ivanti", "Connect Secure", "VPN")
| project UserPrincipalName, IPAddress, SigninTime=TimeGenerated, ResultType;
DeviceNetworkEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(30d)
| where DeviceName has_any ("ivanti", "ics", "pulse")
| project DeviceName, NetTime=Timestamp, RemoteIP, RemoteUrl, InitiatingProcessFileName
| join kind=leftouter suspiciousVpn on $left.RemoteIP == $right.IPAddress
| where SigninTime between (NetTime - 1h .. NetTime + 1h)
| order by NetTime desc
```

Investigate hits with appliance audit trails, configuration diffs, integrity-tool output, IdP risk signals, and firewall flows. Do not delete suspicious content before preserving evidence and consulting incident-response authority.

10. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Technique	Name	Rationale
T1190	Exploit Public-Facing Application	Relevant to exposed remote-access appliances and the reported chain
T1105	Ingress Tool Transfer	Unauthorized appliance file placement is a related hunt hypothesis, not a confirmed action for every target
T1098	Account Manipulation	Review remote-access account and authorization changes after suspected

		compromise

11. Validation / Lab Testing

No exploit reproduction or intrusive appliance testing was performed. QA verified the CISA KEV entry, CISA alert, vendor remediation framing, structured tables, embedded KQL/SPL queries, PDF rendering, and extracted text. Operators must validate appliance versions, integrity, and maintenance outcomes in their approved environment.

12. Recommended Actions Summary

Priority	Action
1	Identify all ICS appliances, including HA/DR nodes and administrative interfaces.
2	Apply Ivanti's current fixed-release guidance and confirm patch levels on every node.
3	Run and retain Ivanti Integrity Checker Tool results; treat unexplained findings as incident evidence.
4	Hunt for appliance configuration/content change, novel VPN access, and administrative actions; rotate credentials and sessions if compromise is suspected.

13. References

- [1] CISA, Known Exploited Vulnerabilities Catalog. https://www.cisa.gov/sites/default/files/feeds/known_exploited_vulnerabilities.json
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- [3] Ivanti, Security Advisory Ivanti Connect Secure (CVE-2026-104935). https://hub.ivanti.com/s/article/Security-Advisory-Ivanti-Connect-Secure-CVE-2026-104935
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